Current Affairs — 17 October

Daily class (Saturday) | Current affairs + one-liners + Monument of the day: Rameswaram + Revision

*English rendering of the Hindi class transcript. Garbled names/figures in the auto-generated transcript are marked **[unclear]** or **[as heard]**. Answer options were on screen (not in the transcript), so Part B gives question → correct answer.*

PART A — TOPIC-WISE NOTES WITH QUICK REVISION

1. Ramsar Sites — India now has 103

- **Sukhna Lake (Chandigarh)** and **Saur (Sau) Lake (Mainpuri, Uttar Pradesh)** added → India has **103 Ramsar sites** (Glow Lake, Arunachal = 101; **Sukhna = 102; Saur = 103**). The last UP site added earlier: **Jai Prakash Narayan (JP Narayan) Bird Sanctuary** [as stated].
- **Ramsar:** Convention signed **2 Feb 1971** at **Ramsar, Iran**; **2 Feb = World Wetlands Day**. Wetland = marshy area rich in water, visited by migratory birds. India joined in **1982**; first Indian site **Chilika Lake** (added **1981** [as stated]).
- **Sukhna: man-made** lake at the foot of the **Shivalik (outer Himalaya)**. **Saur Lake: freshwater**, linked with **Ganga water**; 'pala' fish [as stated] common; nearest bird sanctuary **Samaan**.
- **Records:** largest Ramsar site **Sundarbans Delta**; smallest **Renuka Lake**; most sites in a state **Tamil Nadu (20)**, 2nd **UP**; India **1st in Asia**, **3rd in the world** [as stated by a student].
- **Montreux Record** (sites in danger): **Keoladeo Ghana (Rajasthan)** and **Loktak Lake (Manipur)** — Manipur ≠ Mainpuri.

⚡ QUICK REVISION

› Ramsar total 103: Glow Lake 101, Sukhna 102 (Chandigarh), Saur 103 (Mainpuri, UP) | Convention 2 Feb 1971, Iran | India joined 1982

› Largest Sundarbans | Smallest Renuka | Most: Tamil Nadu (20) then UP | First: Chilika | Montreux: Keoladeo + Loktak

2. Reports & Indices — Henley Passport, Global Hunger Index, World Food Day

- **Henley Passport Index (Oct 2026):** India **84th** (Oct 2025: **85**; July 2026: **81**); rank shared with **Algeria and Mauritania**; **199 countries/destinations**; shows how many countries a passport can enter **visa-free**; updated **4 times a year**; issued on **IATA** data [as stated]. **Top 3: Singapore, Japan, South Korea**; **last: Afghanistan**.
- **Global Hunger Index 2026:** 4 indicators — **undernourishment, child wasting, child mortality, child stunting**; prepared by **Welthungerhilfe** (and partner [as heard]); score **0–100**; **122 countries**; **India ranked 100** (2025: **102 of 123**) — 'serious' category, little improvement. **Pakistan 106**; Pakistan and Afghanistan worst on food insecurity.
- **World Food Day — 16 Oct** (FAO founded **16 Oct 1945**; HQ **Rome, Italy**); theme **'Innovate Today, Nourish Tomorrow'** [as heard]; FAO head **Qu Dongyu** (China).
- **Mahila Kisan Diwas — 15 Oct 2026**, **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar International Centre, Delhi**; by the **Ministry of Agriculture**; theme **'Role of Women Farmers in Developing Agriculture and Developed India'**; first observed **2007**; UN declared **2026 = International Year of the Woman Farmer** (2025 was dedicated to glaciers/quantum science). Agriculture is a **State List** subject.
- **Scheme renaming:** see Section 3.

⚡ QUICK REVISION

› Henley: India 84 (Oct 2026), 85 (Oct 2025), 81 (Jul 2026) | Top Singapore, Japan, S. Korea | Last Afghanistan

› GHI 2026: India 100/122 (2025: 102/123), 4 indicators | Pakistan 106 | World Food Day 16 Oct, FAO Rome 1945

› Mahila Kisan Diwas 15 Oct (Delhi, Agri Ministry) | 2026 = Intl Year of Woman Farmer

3. Schemes Renamed & Government Decisions

- **National Social Assistance Programme** renamed **Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana** (Hindi version only); period **2026–27 to 2030–31 (5 years)**; outlay **₹53,428 crore**; pensions/subsidies/social support; **28 states + 8 UTs**. Persons with disability aged up to 79: **₹375/month**; age **80+: ₹625/month** [as stated].

- **Other renamed schemes:** Indira Gandhi Old Age Pension → **PM Vriddh Avastha Pension Yojana**; Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension → **PM Vidhwa Pension Yojana**; National Family Benefit Scheme → **PM Parivar Labh Yojana**.
- **MGNREGA** new name: **Viksit Bharat — G RAM G Yojana** (from **1 July 2026**); **125 days** of work; rural level.
- **Sugarcane committee** (farmers' problems) headed by **Ramesh Chand** (former **NITI Aayog** member). Sugarcane comes under **FRP — Fair and Remunerative Price**, **not MSP**; **MSP** covers **22 crops** (2 new crops being added) [as stated]; **UP** is the top sugarcane producer; ethanol is made from sugarcane. **NITI Aayog**: Chair = PM; VC **Ashok Lahiri** [as stated]; CEO **Anurag Jain**.
- **Naushena Shaurya Vatika** (Rajnath Singh) — **Lucknow**. Rajnath Singh warned Pakistan of a firm reply.
- **Ram Nath Kovind's autobiography** Hindi version launched by CM **Yogi Adityanath** in **Lucknow** (on the **Gomti**); English title heard as '...of the Indian Republic' **[unclear]**; Hindi title **'Nij Jeevan Ki Chhata'** [as heard].
- **Himachal Pradesh**: **18th state** — **25 Jan 1971**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› NSAP → PM Samajik Sahayata Yojana (2026–31, ₹53,428 cr) | ₹375 (disabled ≤79), ₹625 (80+)

› MGNREGA → Viksit Bharat G RAM G Yojana, 125 days, from 1 Jul 2026

› Sugarcane → FRP (not MSP) | Committee head → Ramesh Chand | NITI CEO Anurag Jain

4. International & Appointments

- **AI avatar 'Devi'** launched by the **Indian Embassy in Jakarta, Indonesia** (for Durga Puja); answers in **English and Bahasa Indonesia**; gives info on culture, travel, scholarships, business and investment; 1 lakh+ Indians live in Indonesia. Indonesia: SE Asia; capital **Jakarta** (Java island); new capital **Nusantara** (East Kalimantan, Borneo). Other Indian AI avatars: **Saundarya** (Kannada), **Leeza** (Odia). 'AI' moving to '**SI**' = Super Intelligence.
- **Shah Rukh Khan** — brand ambassador of **Vi (Vodafone Idea)**.
- **UNGA 81st session President (elected): Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh) [as stated]; meeting in **New York**; India's **S. Jaishankar** attended.
- **PM of Slovenia: Janez Janša** (4th term).
- **Reeva (Riva) Nawati** [as heard] awarded the **Hillary Rodham Clinton Award**.
- **Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028** — **Bhubaneswar**. Another question (garbled) answered **Chandigarh**.
- **ICC T20 World Cup 2028** final: **19 Nov 2028**, **Australia** (19 Nov 2023 = India lost the ODI WC final to Australia). IMF 2027 meeting to be hosted by Pakistan [as stated].

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Devi AI avatar → Jakarta (Indonesia) | Saundarya → Kannada | Leeza → Odia | Nusantara new capital

› UNGA-81 President → Khalilur Rahman (Bangladesh) | Slovenia PM → Janez Janša (4th term)

› SRK → Vi | Asian Indoor Athletics 2028 → Bhubaneswar

5. Days (Dates to Remember)

- **World No Tobacco Day — 31 May**; **World Milk Day — 1 June** (National Milk Day — 26 Nov); **Global Day of Parents — 1 June**; **International Sex Workers Day — 2 June**; **Telangana Formation Day — 2 June (2014)**; **World Bicycle Day — 3 June**; **World Environment Day — 5 June**; **World Food Safety Day — 7 June**.
- **Book release:** 'Indian Olympic Gold: Hockey Triumph at Amsterdam' [title as heard] — released by **P.T. Usha and Dilip Tirkey**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› No Tobacco 31 May | Milk Day & Parents Day 1 Jun | Sex Workers 2 Jun | Bicycle 3 Jun | Environment 5 Jun | Food Safety 7 Jun

6. Sports

- **U-23 World Wrestling Championships** (**Las Vegas, USA**): **Vishwajeet** [surname as heard] — **Silver** in **55 kg** — India's first medal in this category; lost the gold by **one point** (12–13) to a **Georgian** wrestler.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› U-23 Wrestling → Vishwajeet, silver (55 kg), Las Vegas, lost by 1 point to Georgia

7. Himachal Pradesh — Spiti Solar + Festivals

- **First battery-storage solar project** of Himachal (and at very high altitude) at **Kaza, Spiti Valley (Lahaul-Spiti)**: battery storage ensures power in snowy winters; capacity **2 MW**; about **36 lakh units/year**.
- **Beas River:** originates and ends in **India**; joins the **Sutlej** at **Harike Wetland, Punjab**.
- **HP culture: Ranale** festival (fairies, red face cover, temple dance) [as heard]; **Nati** dance; fairs — **Kullu Dussehra** (most famous), **Minjar Mela**, **Lavi Fair**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Spiti (Kaza) solar + battery → HP's first | 2 MW, 36 lakh units/yr | Beas joins Sutlej at Harike (Punjab)

› HP: Ranale festival, Nati dance, Kullu Dussehra, Minjar Mela, Lavi Fair

8. MONUMENT OF THE DAY — RAMESWARAM

- **Pamban Island, Tamil Nadu**; **Pamban Bridge** lies between the **Bay of Bengal and Indian Ocean**; dedicated to **Lord Shiva** — one of the **12 Jyotirlingas**; linked to Lord Ram's bridge to Lanka (**Setu Nagari**).
- Developed by **Pandya, Chola and Nayak** rulers; started by a **Pandya** king in the **12th century**; **Dravidian** style; famous **long corridor**; about **22 holy wells** (teerthams).
- Part of the **Char Dham**: **Badrinath, Puri, Dwarka, Rameswaram**. Nearby **Dhanushkodi** — the end of India's land (called a 'ghost town'); **Agni Teertham** — place of holy bath. The BRICS backdrop image was this temple.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Rameswaram: Pamban Island (TN), Shiva, Jyotirlinga, Dravidian, 12th c., 22 wells, Char Dham, Dhanushkodi, Agni Teertham

9. Revision & Announcements

- **Revision:** IDBI sale → Fairfax (Canada); LNG No. 1 supplier → Oman; Cambrian Patrol Gold → Assam Regiment; friendliest city → Mérida; Costa Rica embassy → San José; Bharat Rice → Army; World Standards Day → 14 Oct; handed to Navy 16 Oct → Samarthak; Bloomberg New Economy Forum → Delhi; Commonwealth Cue Sports → India 13 medals.
- **Offer (today only):** Testbook **Super Pass ₹799** for **12 months** (SSC, Railways, Banking, Teaching, State exams; theory, crash courses, mocks, tests) with a **free book**; code **Kriti10**. 11 AM light-GK class today; **18 Oct 7:00/7:30 AM** weekly class + announcements (GD/MTS on YouTube).

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Super Pass ₹799/12 months, code Kriti10 (today only) | 18 Oct 7:30 AM announcements

PART B — ALL MCQs FROM THE CLASS (Question → Correct Answer)

Question as asked in class → correct answer given by the teacher.

#	Question	Answer
1	Total Ramsar sites in India after Sukhna & Saur?	**103**
2	Ramsar site no. 101 / 102 / 103?	**Glow Lake / Sukhna Lake / Saur Lake**
3	Ramsar Convention — year, date, place?	**1971; 2 Feb; Ramsar, Iran**
4	Sukhna Lake: location and type?	**Chandigarh; man-made (Shivalik foothills)**
5	Saur Lake location? Nearest bird sanctuary?	**Mainpuri (UP); Samaan**
6	Last UP Ramsar site before Saur?	**Jai Prakash Narayan Sanctuary [as stated]**
7	Largest / smallest Ramsar site?	**Sundarbans Delta / Renuka Lake**
8	State with most Ramsar sites?	**Tamil Nadu (20); then UP**
9	First Indian Ramsar site and year India joined?	**Chilika (1981); India joined 1982**
10	Montreux Record — Indian sites?	**Keoladeo Ghana (Rajasthan), Loktak Lake (Manipur)**
11	World No Tobacco Day?	**31 May**

#	Question	Answer
12	Asian Indoor Athletics Championships 2028 host city?	**Bhubaneswar**
13	India’s rank in Henley Passport Index (Oct 2026)?	**84**
14	Henley: Top 3 and last?	**Singapore, Japan, South Korea; Afghanistan last**
15	Henley: India’s ranks Oct 2025 / July 2026?	**85 / 81**
16	Book on Amsterdam Olympic hockey gold — released by?	**P.T. Usha & Dilip Tirkey**
17	World Milk Day? Global Day of Parents?	**1 June; 1 June**
18	Mahila Kisan Diwas 2026 — date and place?	**15 Oct; Delhi (Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Centre)**
19	Mahila Kisan Diwas theme?	**Role of Women Farmers in Developing Agriculture and Developed India**
20	UN dedicated 2026 to? 2025 to?	**Women Farmers; Glaciers/Quantum science**
21	International Sex Workers Day? Telangana Formation Day?	**2 June; 2 June 2014**
22	PM of Slovenia (4th term)?	**Janez Janša**
23	New name of National Social Assistance Programme?	**PM Samajik Sahayata Yojana**
24	MGNREGA’s new name?	**Viksit Bharat — G RAM G Yojana (125 days)**
25	Indira Gandhi Old Age / Widow Pension new names?	**PM Vriddh Avastha / PM Vidhwa Pension Yojana**
26	Naushena Shaurya Vatika built at?	**Lucknow**
27	World Bicycle Day? World Environment Day?	**3 June; 5 June**
28	Indian Embassy AI avatar in Indonesia?	**Devi (Jakarta)**
29	Languages of ‘Devi’? Indonesia’s new capital?	**English & Bahasa; Nusantara**
30	AI avatar answering in Kannada / Odia?	**Saundarya / Leeza**
31	Company that appointed Shah Rukh Khan as ambassador?	**Vi (Vodafone Idea)**
32	UNGA 81st session President-elect?	**Khalilur Rahman (Bangladesh)**
33	World Food Safety Day?	**7 June**
34	State with first battery-storage solar project (Spiti)?	**Himachal Pradesh (Kaza); 2 MW**
35	Beas River joins Sutlej at?	**Harike Wetland, Punjab**
36	HP became which state, when?	**18th; 25 Jan 1971**
37	HP fairs?	**Kullu Dussehra, Minjar Mela, Lavi Fair**
38	Sugarcane committee head?	**Ramesh Chand**
39	Sugarcane price comes under? MSP crops?	**FRP; 22 crops**
40	NITI Aayog VC / CEO?	**Ashok Lahiri / Anurag Jain**
41	World Food Day date, FAO HQ, theme?	**16 Oct; Rome; Innovate Today, Nourish Tomorrow**
42	Global Hunger Index 2026 — India’s rank? 4 indicators?	**100/122; undernourishment, wasting, mortality, stunting**
43	Pakistan’s GHI rank?	**106**
44	Ram Nath Kovind’s autobiography Hindi launched in?	**Lucknow (by CM Yogi)**
45	U-23 World Wrestling — Indian silver medallist?	**Vishwajeet (55 kg)**
46	Hillary Rodham Clinton Award to?	**Reeva Nawati [as heard]**
47	Rameswaram — island, bridge, deity?	**Pamban Island; Pamban Bridge; Shiva**
48	Char Dham places?	**Badrinath, Puri, Dwarka, Rameswaram**
49	Land’s end of India near Rameswaram?	**Dhanushkodi**
50	Rameswaram built by (rulers)? Style?	**Pandya, Chola, Nayak; Dravidian**
51	Super Pass price / validity / code?	**₹799; 12 months; Kriti10**